



3D photography

Fujifilm FinePix REAL 3D W1 claims to be the world's first Point-And-Shoot Digital 3D Camera

More Android

HTC to make Google's new phone expected in 2010



OSX 10.6 Snow Leopard

No hibernating cat this

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Price: Rs. 1800 (single user)

Requirements

Intel-based Mac or Macbook,
8 GB installation space, Apple
Tiger or Leopard

RATINGS

Features.....	7.5
Performance	7.5
Usability	7.5
Value	8
Overall	7.5

Touted as being faster than its predecessor, OS X 10.6 boasts of a native 64-bit design, improved multi-core efficiency is more resource frugal, and has a smaller footprint – 10 GB as opposed to the 16 GB on Leopard. Of course, it loses printer drivers and Power PC binaries in lieu of this, the later meaning 10.6 will run exclusively on Intel hardware. On account of the smaller footprint it installs around 35 per cent faster.

More than 4 GB of memory is addressable as the OS natively runs in 64-bit mode. Apple also dropped in Grand Central Dispatch (GCD hereon) – a system that maintains queues and blocks at an OS level, taking much

of the problems associated with a multi-threaded core away from developers, by providing a simple interface where they only need to tag individual clusters of work/tasks. The last significant change is the OpenCL API for utilising the processing power in any GPU later than the GeForce 8600 series.

Working with images has become faster using iPhoto and the HDD subsystem also seems to have sped up. Funnily, Photoshop CS4 shows no increment in performance, while CineBench R10 gave a 2 per cent higher CPU score.

Expose now has text labels for each window when zoomed-out – useful if there are many images open. The new Stacks allows scrolling in grid view – nifty and a

better file viewing experience in general. QuickTime X (10) has a much cleaner interface, for example, move the mouse away and the video loses all borders and buttons and there's also a new system for encoding video and audio clips and even captured screens. The improved Dock now allows dragging files to a relevant application.

The changes seem small, and those under the hood are yet to realise any potential as third party application performance lags. The changes to the interface are cursory too, but they all add up to improved usability. It's not path breaking, but the upgrade from Leopard costs a mere Rs. 1,800, making it something that every Mac user will want to consider.

Canon PIXMA iP4760

A little brighter than we'd like

Canon's brand new offering to customers looking for home photo printers is the PIXMA iP4760. The printer has an elegant design, with a good build quality.

Setting up the cartridges isn't as simple as the USB installation. There are five cartridges in all, and the process is a bit cumbersome. The tray at the top is somewhat misleading since paper can be fed through the tray at the bottom. Fortunately, the manual explains it all.

But being a photo printer, print quality is more important than speed. There isn't much difference in the different modes with time and quality. The prints look good. Our only complaint is the

colours looked washed out in the final prints. Text prints suffer the same problem but the clarity in all prints is fine and in the case of text, crisp and rounded.

You only have to shell out Rs. 8,155 for this photo printer. For a home printer, it may seem like a lot, but is actually worth it when you think value for money. The colours could have been a bit more saturated though.



Contact

Canon India Private Ltd.

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Web: www.canon.co.in

Price: Rs. 8,155

Specifications

Resolution: 9600x2400 dpi;

Media: A4, envelopes, photo stickers, T-shirt transfers;

Dimensions: 431x296x153 mm,
Weight: 5.7 kg

RATINGS

Features.....	7
Performance	7
Build quality	7
Value for money	7
Overall	7